



Decoy Ducks

Education Crate Guide

Informational Readings, Activities, and More (K-8)


DukeEngage

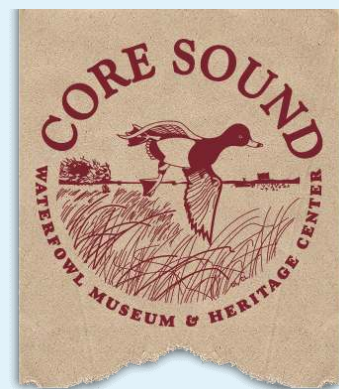


Table of Contents

Introduction -----	1
What's in this Crate -----	3
Conceptual Materials -----	5
Background and Overview -----	5
All about Ducks -----	7
Decoy Ducks -----	9
Duck Hunting -----	11
Activities Summary -----	15
Activity 1 -----	16
Activity 2 -----	50
Activity 3 -----	52
Activity 4 -----	54
Activity 5 -----	59
Activity 6 -----	61
Activity 7 -----	73
Activity 8 -----	74
Activity 9 -----	75
Activity 10 -----	77
Activity 11 -----	81
Activity 12 -----	99
Activity 13 -----	112
Activity 14 -----	113
Activity 15 -----	116
Supplementary Activities -----	119

Decoy Carving in Down East

Welcome to your Core Sound Decoy Duck Education Crate, designed to teach students K-8 about the long-standing craft of decoy duck carving and its significance to the Down East culture and history! We hope this will be a valuable, engaging, and interactive resource for your classroom.

Why Decoys Ducks?

There are five crates in this education series: **ghost forests**, **commercial fishing**, **community mapping**, **the Cape Lookout lighthouse**, and **decoy ducks**. These subjects were chosen for their importance to the region. In particular, decoy ducks have emerged as a symbol of the maritime and fishing communities that define Down East. A craft that was once honed by necessity has now become a distinct and popular art form in the area.

How to Use this Education Crate

This education crate serves as a “choose your own adventure” resource. You may elect to complete some or all of the included activities depending on your allotted times and students’ grade level. You may also choose to incorporate the information from the Conceptual Materials section into your own unique lesson plan.

About the Core Sound Museum

The Core Sound Waterfowl Museum and Heritage Center’s mission with these crates aligns with the vision for our museum. We aim to “establish a facility that will enhance the community, state, and region by creating a resource which brings together the historical, cultural, artistic, environmental, and educational elements needed to preserve the rich waterfowl heritage of eastern North Carolina associated with the Core Sound area.” We hope these crates can transform classrooms into learning spaces that will connect students across the region to the Down East landscape and living heritage.

Acknowledgments

This crate is the work of many DukeEngage students and Core Sound Museum staff. In addition, we would like to thank the following people or groups for their invaluable contributions.

- Chris Yeomans, for generously sharing his expertise in duck hunting and gorgeous pictures, both of which are used extensively in the Duck Hunting section of Conceptual Materials.
- The Core Sound Decoy Guild, for sharing their expertise on decoy carving, which is featured in the Decoy Ducks section of Conceptual Materials

Citations

Numerous resources were consulted to make this education crate a reality. These are presented below, and they are a great way to learn even more about the Down East area.

- *Living at the Water's Edge* by Barbara Garrity-Blake and Karen Willis Amspacher. The University of North Carolina Press, 2017.
- North Carolina Ducks, Geese, and Swans: A 35 Species ID Guide, Avian Report. <https://avianreport.com/north-carolina-ducks-geese-swans-id-guide/>.
- Coloring guides from Knutson's Sporting Goods. https://www.knutsondecoys.com/decoy_paint/parker_coatings.html.

What's in this Crate

Below is a list of items in this education crate on decoy ducks. Most items are associated with an activity, and a few are standalone artifacts that may be useful during instruction. However, please view these labels as mere recommendations and disregard them as necessary to maximize their educational potential.

Standalone Artifacts

- Photo album
- Teacher feedback notebook

Activity Artifacts

Activity 1

- Duck-shaped cookie cutters
- Air-dry modeling clay
- *Mid-Atlantic & Southeast Duck Migration Guide*

Activity 2

- Decoy ducks (5, mallard, pintail, redhead, black duck, canvasback)
- *The Super Book of Ducks*

Activity 4

- Decoy-placing maps and cutouts

Activity 5

- "Decoy, Carver, Fowl, Drake, Hen" card deck

Activity 7

- Duck species posters (2 versions)

Activity 8

- Duck duck goose cards and instructions sheet

Activity 13

- *Duck Hunting* by Lisa M. Bolt Simons
- *Bird Watch* by Storey Publishing

- *Duck Hunt* by Ryan Eubank, illustrated by Louise Saunders
- *Bird Dogs* by Ryan Eubank, illustrated by Louise Saunders
- *The Duck Shack* by Kevin Lovegreen, illustrated by Margarita Sikorskaia
- *Ducks Don't Get Wet* by Augusta Goldin, illustrated by Helen Davie

Activity 14

- Camou clothing and orange hunting vest
- Duck call

Activity 15

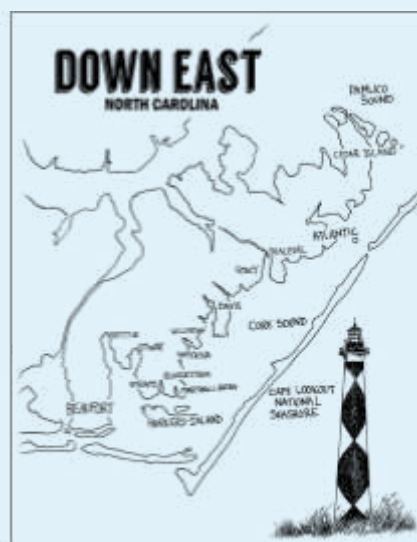
- Decoy carving poster

Background and Overview

In this section, we briefly introduce the Down East communities. Then, we discuss the history of duck hunting in Down East, noting the influences of market demand and governmental regulations. We will close with how decoy ducks — a unique tradition of this area — fits into the whole picture.

Where Are We?

Down East is located on the southern end of North Carolina's Outer banks. The area itself consists of 13 distinct communities: Atlantic, Bettie, Cedar Island, Davis, Gloucester, Harker's Island, Marshallberg, Otway, Sea Level, Smyrna, Stacy, Straits, and Williston. This location is one of the earliest settled places in North Carolina, and it has a long and rich history. Major commercial activities in Down East include hunting waterfowl (including ducks), fishing, and farming.



Map of Down East

Historical Duck Hunting

The marshes and open waters of the Outer Banks made it a popular place for waterfowl to gather. In the earliest days, settlers hunted ducks as a way to feed their families.

Beginning in the early 1900s, large-scale hunting of waterfowl popularized in Down East. This was due to both restaurants' demand for ducks and the millinery trade's demand for egret, heron, and swan feathers. During this period, ducks were hunted in very large numbers, packed in ice, and sent to high-end restaurants in the North.

Regulation and Evolution

Market hunting of waterfowl was not sustainable, and it was eventually ended by the Migratory Bird Treaty Act of 1918. However, duck hunting did not stop, but instead evolved into a recreational activity. In fact, many Hunt Clubs established by wealthy people to hunt ducks for enjoyment were established after the banning of market-scale hunting.

Today, duck hunting remains a central part of Down East culture. People in Down East hunt ducks both as a way to gather additional food for their families but also as a way to connect with their land, friends, and tradition. An important part of Down East duck hunting is the use of decoy ducks.

Decoy Ducks

Decoy ducks are a central part of Down East duck hunting. Hunters would place decoy ducks out in the field to attract real ducks to the spot. Over the years, decoy carving skills were gradually perfected to stunning heights. Nowadays, intricate decoys are not simply useful, but also collectible. The Core Sound Waterfowl Museum and Heritage center features a large collection of decoy ducks and other waterfowl.

All about Ducks

We introduce the types of ducks in Down East and what makes the region so abundant in waterfowl. In addition, we also discuss ducks' behaviors and adaptations to provide more background information on the animal itself.

Types of Ducks in Coastal NC

The Down East area is characterized by expansive marshes and open waters, making the region an ideal spot for ducks and other waterfowls to mate and refuel in the winter. The region is part of the Atlantic Flyway. During peak migration times, ducks come to the region in the thousands and darken the sky with their flocks.



Marshes in Down East

The types of ducks that visit the Outer Banks can be classified into diving and putter ducks. Diving ducks dive deep into waters to get their food, and some examples include the red heads and black heads. Putter ducks look for food near the water's surface, and one well-known example is the mallard. Duck hunting in Down East mainly involves hunting diving ducks, especially the red head, which is a local delicacy.

What to Know About Ducks?

Ducks are a type of waterfowl – aquatic, swimming birds that also include geese and swans. They weigh 2–3 pounds, with adult ducks having a length between 18 to 28 inches and a wingspan between 30 to 40 inches.

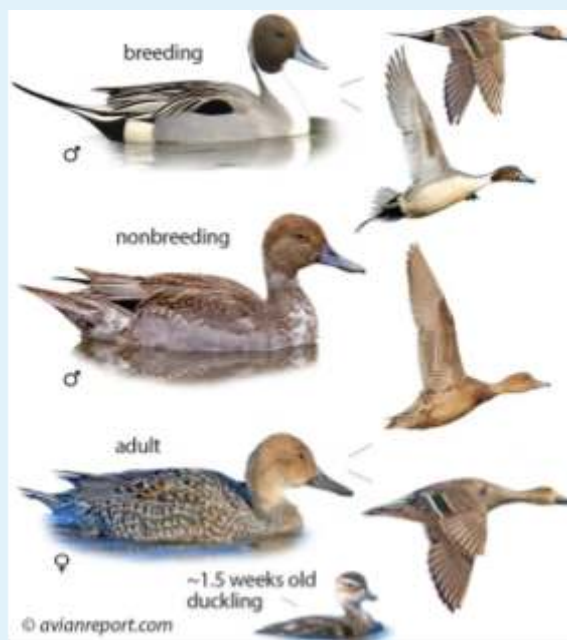
As omnivores, ducks eat a varied diet consisting of both plants and animals. These include aquatic plants and grains, as well as insects, earthworms, and small fish.

Male ducks are called drakes, while female ducks are called hens.

Over 40 different species of waterfowl live in North America. These include the Mallard (*anas platyrhynchos*), famous for its brown and white body with green head, the Redhead (*aythya americana*), and Northern Pintail (*anas acuta*)



Redhead Duck



Northern Pintail

Adaptations

Famously, ducks migrate for the winter, seeking areas with warmer lakes and more plentiful food to survive the harsh weather. North American ducks, such as Mallards, typically migrate 850–1,500 miles, landing in warmer areas such as the southeastern United States. Carteret County and the outer banks are often frequented by ducks. During migration, ducks tend to fly in a “V” shape to conserve energy, as ducks further back in the formation use updraft produced by the ducks at the front to gain extra lift.

In addition to migration, ducks utilize other adaptations to survive, such as:

- Broad, flat bills that help filter food from water
- Secretion of waxy oil, which allow for waterproof feathers, keeping them light and dry
- Webbed feet, which allow for swimming

Decoy Ducks

Here, we discuss the processes behind how decoy ducks are made and used. We will also introduce a few famous Down East decoy carvers as well as how they are keeping this important tradition alive.

How Are Decoy Ducks Made?

Carver Gerald Davis, a board member on the Core Sound Decoy Guild, “explains that it’s ‘simple’ to carve a decoy duck: You start with a piece of wood and carve away everything that doesn’t look like a duck.” More specifically, this process involves carving rough shapes out of wood, sanding the rough edges down, and painting.



The Birth of a Decoy

Traditionally, decoys were made from driftwood, abandoned wooden poles, and other cheap, accessible forms of wood. Carvers then carved away using handheld tools like hatchets or drawknives. While the bodies and heads of ducks are often carved separately, individual hunters and regional artists have developed their own styles of carving. For example, Harker’s Island carvers often cut the bodies of these wooden decoys in a “V” shape, ensuring they sit steady in choppy Core Sound waters.

Paint application also varies by area and use. Hunters often prioritize function over hyper-realism, though collectors and artists might devote more time to accurate coloring and bird plumage. Additionally, decoys are finished with a matte paint to avoid any glare that, on a bright day, might scare away potential waterfowl.

How Are Decoy's Used?

Decoys are placed out on the water in strategic formations. This involves considering wind alignment, the landing area for the ducks, and the distance from a hunter's blind (the shelter used to conceal them). To further attract prey to the shooting range, hunters will use whistles that mimic duck calls, working to convince passing waterfowl that the area is safe.

Efforts to Keep the Tradition Alive

For generations, the craft of carving decoys has been passed down through families. The aforementioned Core Sound Decoy Guild plays a large role in preserving this history and it's their hope that decoy duck carving will be recognized as a folk art form. The Guild hosts workshops and classes, supports educational youth programs, and organizes an annual festival showcasing carvings. Similarly, The Core Sound Waterfowl Museum & Heritage Center offers many permanent exhibits for studying past and present decoy duck carvings and the multitude of different styles and persons involved.

Famous Down East Carvers

While there are many individuals Down East who practice decoy duck carving, a few notable artists who have been vocal about both their craft and preserving the tradition include Stan Rule, Homer Fulcher, Brother Gaskill, and Jason Michels.



Hunter, dog, and an array of decoys

Duck Hunting

In this section, we discuss the process of duck hunting in detail. This includes decoy placement, blind setup, and more.

Camouflage

In order to conceal themselves from ducks, Down East hunters often employ elaborate camouflage. The process of camouflaging can be divided up into two parts: blind camouflage and clothing camouflage.

A blind is a place where hunters stay when they are waiting for ducks to come, and duck hunters want their blinds to blend into the surrounding landscape as much as possible.

There are three types of blinds: stake, boat, and shore.

- Stake blinds are built upon platforms in the water supported on stilts. Often, they are created from old piers. In order to set up the actual blind, hunters would often build a wooden “hut” which they could dismantle and assemble onto the pier. As a finishing touch, these blinds are covered in foliage to make them blend into the marsh. A popular way to do this is to put myrtle branches all over the blind.



A stake blind

- Boat blinds are constructed on top of boats. To make it hard for ducks to distinguish, hunters would go long distances to completely cover their boat in straw or foliage. Boat blinds have the advantage of being mobile. If a location is not good for hunting ducks, the hunter can simply steer the boat to a different location.



A boat blind

- Shore blinds are small huts set up near bodies of water. In protected areas of Down East, setting up shore blinds requires obtaining registration from the parks service. These blinds usually feature a frame made from chicken wire or other types of bendable, strong material. Then, the hunters would put grass mats on top so the whole set up disappears into the marsh landscape.



A shore blind

In addition to staying inside a blind, hunters also camouflage themselves so ducks won't notice them. During duck hunting, everything the hunters wear is camou. Sometimes, hunters would even use camou face paint!

Decoy Placement

Hunting ducks requires a large number of decoys. Because ducks usually travel in flocks of hundreds to thousands, a couple of decoy ducks on the water will not attract anything. Typically, a hunter would lay out anywhere from 200–250 decoy ducks near the blind to mimic a true duck flock.



Camouflage

To speed up the process, hunters would sometimes string the decoys on weighted lines or nets. The weight keeps the decoys from getting carried away by waves. By fixing many decoys on a single net or line, hunters can lay out hundreds of decoys much faster. There is science to the placement of decoys, too. For instance, having a more random scatter of ducks instead of lining them up makes the decoy formation look more natural. Arranging the decoys in different formations, perhaps a V-shape, can also make the decoy ducks seem like they are going to a specific location and thus attract real ducks to a desired spot.



Decoy arrays

Decoys work because ducks are looking for two f's: **f**ood and **f**riendship. Decoys might not account for the food, but they might look like potential mates to ducks flying by. This is the reason behind the effectiveness of decoys.

As technology progressed, so did decoys. A popular, recent add-on to decoys is fake wing movement. Having a few decoys in an array which move their wing now and then (called flashing, as the bright parts of the wings flash as they move) can make a decoy formation look much more realistic.

Duck Calls

To boost their chance of catching ducks' attention even more, hunters would also bring duck calls. Sometimes, these calls work well. Other times, they don't. Interestingly enough, just making a weird, loud sound can occasionally attract the duck's attention and make them curious enough to drop by.

Dogs

Many people keep dogs as pets simply for their enjoyment. For hunters in Down East, dogs have a very significant use in addition to emotional companionship: retrieving harvested ducks. When a hunter successfully shoots a duck down, they need a way to retrieve it from the surface of the water. Going down into the marsh, especially in the winter, can be very unpleasant, and this is where dogs come in. Down East hunters would train dogs (labradors are very popular) to fetch their ducks. These trained dogs are much hardier than humans in the cold water.



Dog retrieving a duck

Social Hunting

Hunting ducks can be a social activity, too. Duck hunting provides a chance for family members and friends to hang out together for long periods of time in nature. However, remember that there is always a little bit of friendly competition involved in the process!

Sustainable Hunting

Hunting and killing ducks may not seem like a very environmentally friendly action. However, regulations and the actions of Down East hunters help decrease the environmental impact.

The U.S. Fish and Wildlife Service sets limits on how many ducks or other waterfowl a hunter can kill in a day to ensure that duck flocks will not get over-hunted. Whenever a duck flock comes, a hunter is only allowed three shots. These limits may change depending on the size of duck flocks, too. For instance, the limit may be raised if a population is too big or lowered if a population is not doing well. Hunters also have to purchase permits, and these funds go into conservation efforts.

Down East hunters are also careful to conserve their natural resources, which they depend on, by not hunting too many ducks and making good use out of their resources. Chris Yoemans, a Down Easterner who was interviewed for this topic, recalled that his grandma almost made him eat a sparrow that he shot for fun. If you harvest something, you are expected to eat it. Dishes that integrate the hunted water fowl have become a staple of the culture and the centerpiece of community gatherings. To many of the older generation, this tastes of home.

Activities Summary

This crate includes 14 activities to reinforce your group's learning about decoy ducks! Note that the times are merely an estimate. Learning-based activities are labeled with **(L)**, and game-based activities are labeled with **(G)**. Activities that are more geared toward elementary school children are labeled **(E)**, and activities that are more geared toward middle school children are labeled **(M)**. Activities that are good across grade levels are labeled with both **(E, M)**

-  **Activity 1 (L) (E, M) – “Make Your Own Duck.”** | ⌚ 50 min.
This activity may be extended with two other activities:
 -  **Activity 2 (L) (E, M) “Present a Duck Species”** | ⌚ 30–60 min.
 -  **Activity 3 (G) (E) – “Decoy Hunters** | ⌚ 30–40 min.
-  **Activity 4 (L) (E, M)– “Place Your Decoy”** | ⌚ 30–40 min.
-  **Activity 5 (G) (E) – “Decoy, Carver, Fowl, Drake, Hen”** | ⌚ 20–30 min.
-  **Activity 6 (G) (E) – “Four Duck Corners”** | ⌚ 30 min.
-  **Activity 7 (G) (M) – “Write it, Draw it”** | ⌚ 30–40 min.
-  **Activity 8 (G) (E) – “Duck, Duck, Goose”** | ⌚ 30–40 min
-  **Activities 9 to 11 (G) (E) – Activity Sheets** | ⌚ Flexible
 - **Activity 9 – “Connect the Dots”**
 - **Activity 10 – “Decoy Word Search”**
 - **Activity 11 – “Decoy Duck Bingo”**
 - **Activity 12 – “Duck Coloring Sheets”**
-  **Activity 13 (L) (E) – “Duck Storytime”** | ⌚ Depends on Book
-  **Activity 14 (L) (E, M) – “Dress Like a Hunter”** | ⌚ 40 min.
-  **Activity 15 (L) (M) – “Decoy Duck Video Tutorial** | ⌚ 20–30 min.
-  **Supplementary Activities (L) (E, M)** | ⌚ Various

Activity 1 – “Make Your Own Duck!”

Overview

Have students make a duck model out of air-dry clay or a coloring sheet.

 **50 min.**

Materials

If using clay:

- duck-shaped cookie cutter mold (in crate)
- air-dry modeling clay (in crate)

If coloring:

- duck coloring blank (one copy in binder)
- scissors (not provided)

Both:

- coloring utensils (not provided)
- duck information packet (two versions in binder)
- duck information book (*Mid-Atlantic & Southeast Duck Migration Guide*, in crate)
- duck coloring guide (one copy in binder)
- sample internet resources (optional, one copy in binder)
- access to internet (optional)

Step-by-Step Instructions

1. Have students research a duck species for inspiration for **20 minutes**. Two duck information packets (one more advanced and comprehensive, one shorter and easier to read) and a duck coloring guide are included in the crate. An even more complete book is also available. Make copies of them as needed. Alternatively, students can look up this information online or through databases (a sample internet resources sheet is available if desired). If realism is not a concern or time is an issue, students can also skip this step and color to their imagination later on.
2. Have students prepare a duck-shaped air-dry clay mold with the cookie cutter, or grab a blank duck coloring sheet. Let the clay have some time to dry. If desired, the blank clay duck can be made before step 1 to have time to dry.

3. Decorate the ducks! Use pens, markers, sharpies, and other coloring utensils, and make sure to add spots for eyes, wings, and feet.
4. If using a coloring sheet, have students cut out the duck.

Extension Activities

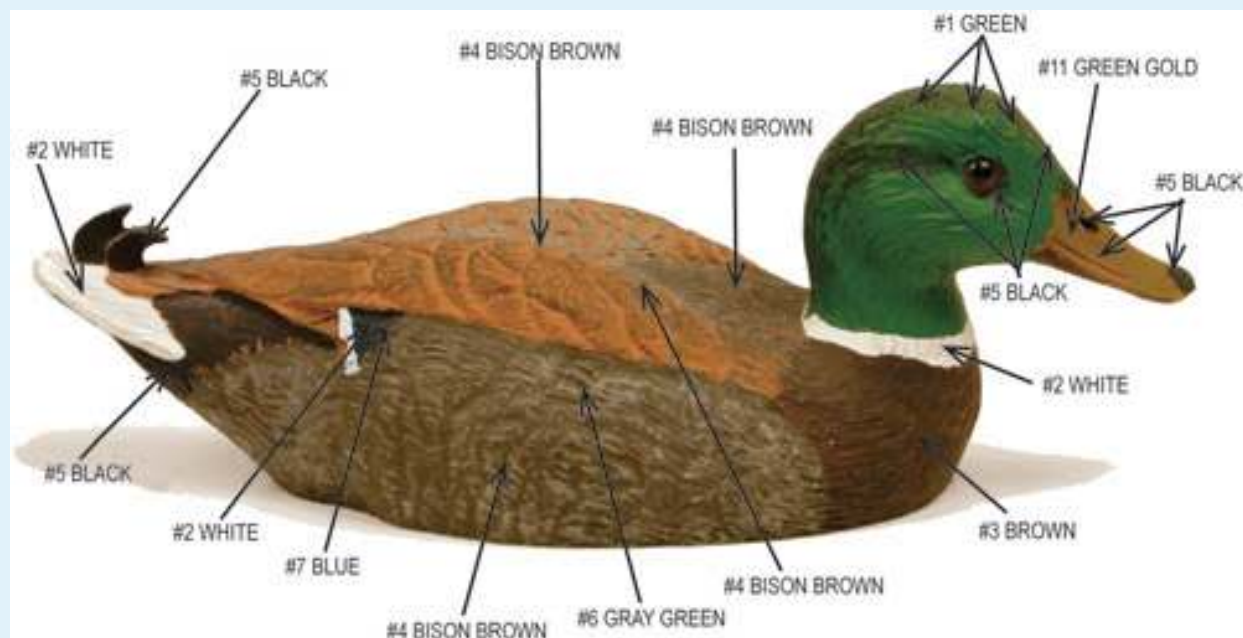
Time to have fun with your ducks! There are several activities that students may use their ducks for:

- Activity 2 - "Present a Duck Species"
- Activity 3 - "Decoy Hunters" - NOTE: If you already have a set of ducks, it may be more enjoyable to create another set of ducks specifically for this activity. Instructions are provided on that activity's sheet.

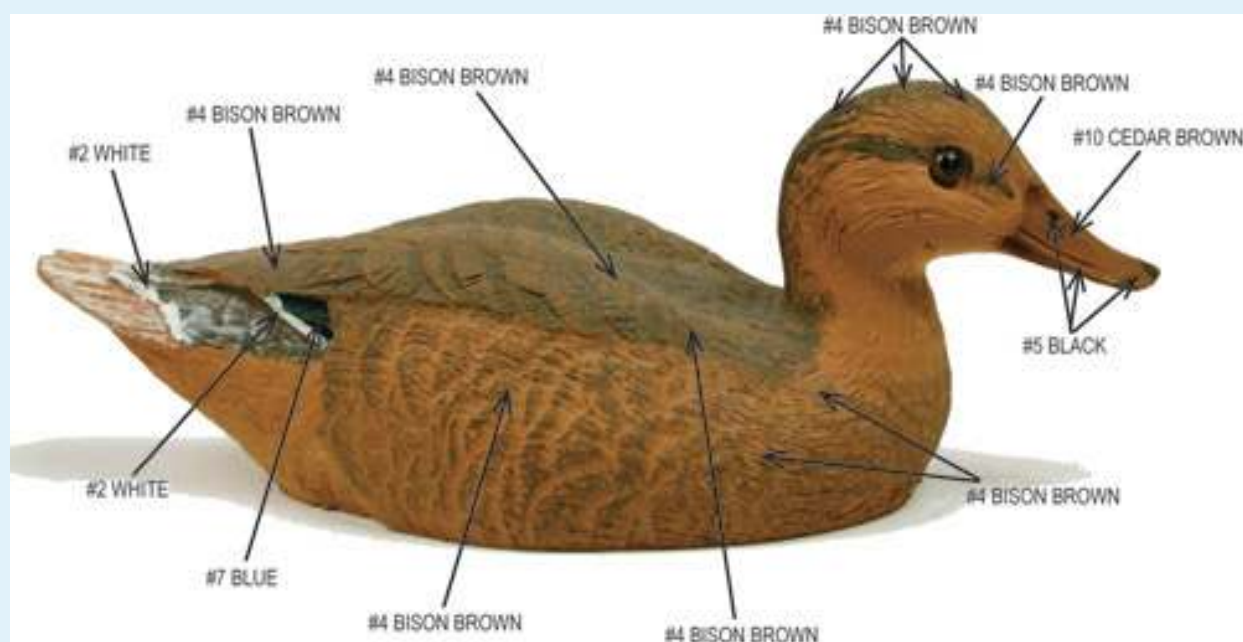
Duck Coloring Guide

1. Mallard

Male (drake):

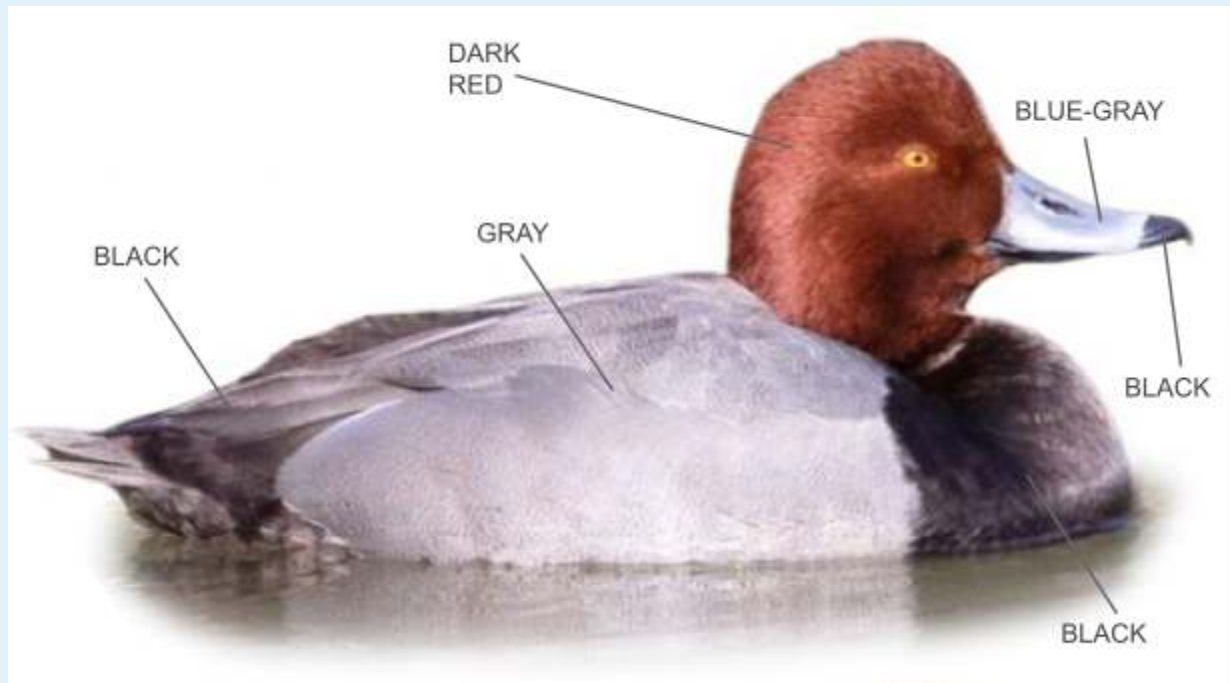


Female (hen):



2. Redhead

Male (drake):

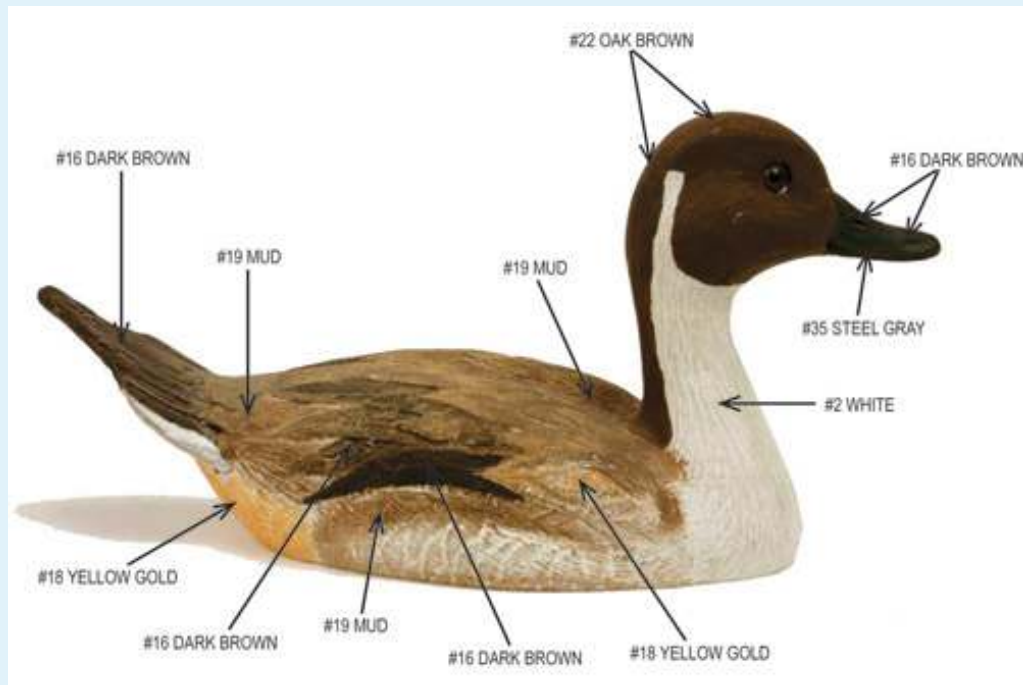


Female (hen):

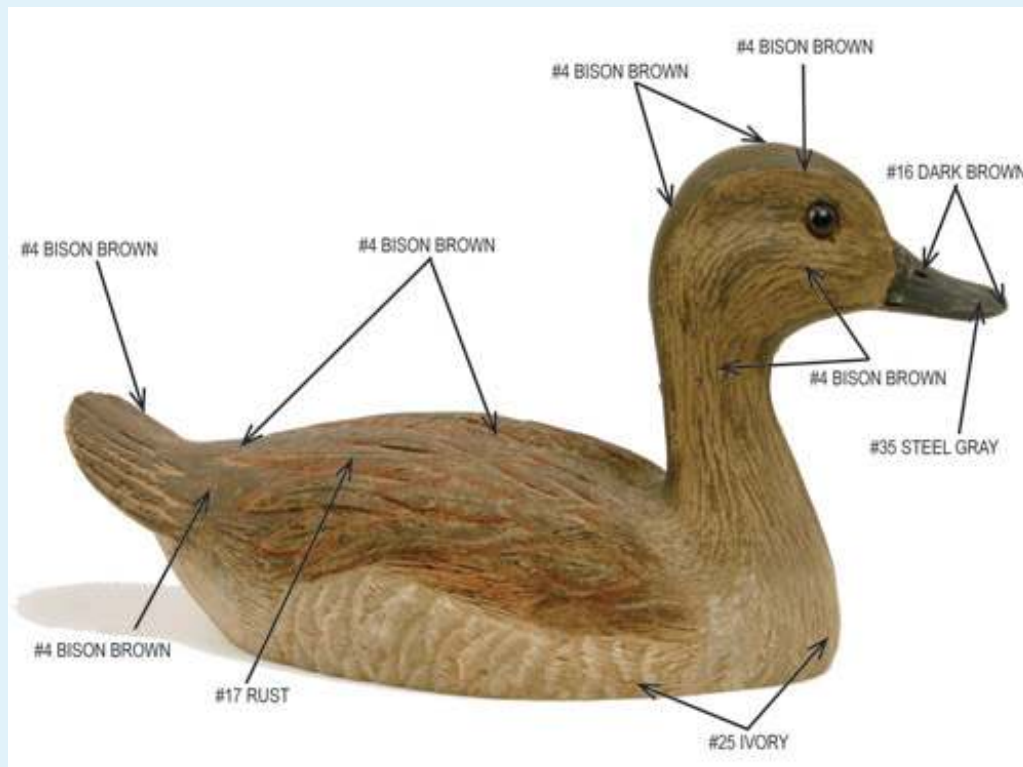


3. Northern Pintail

Male (drake):

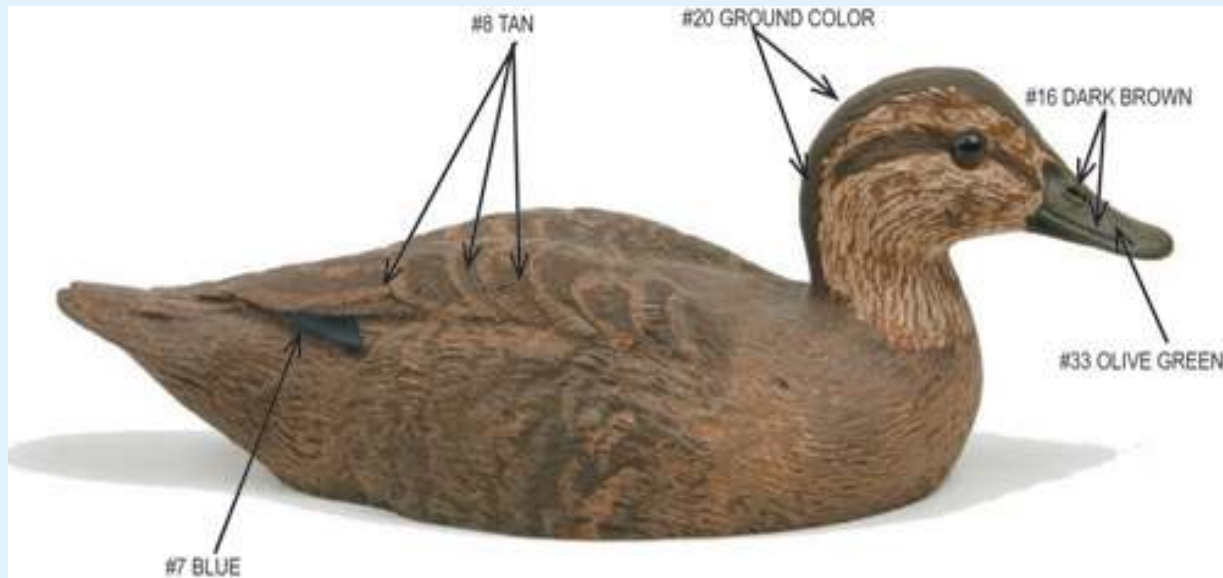


Female (hen):



4. Black Duck

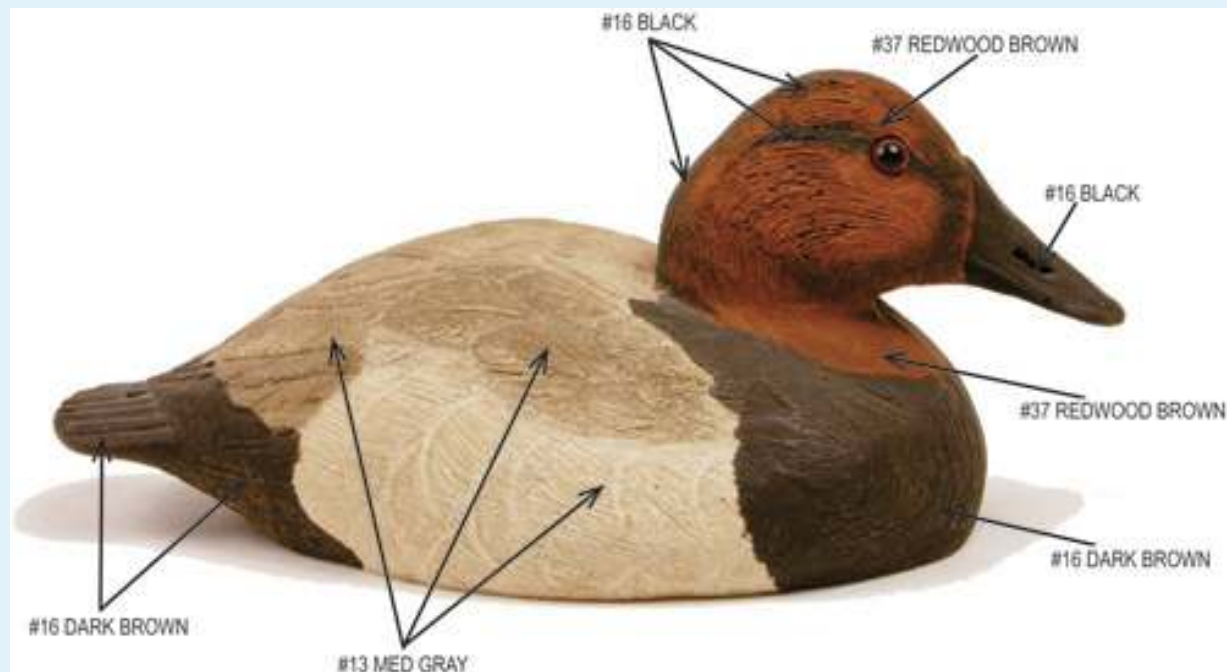
Males and females look very similar. Female (hen):



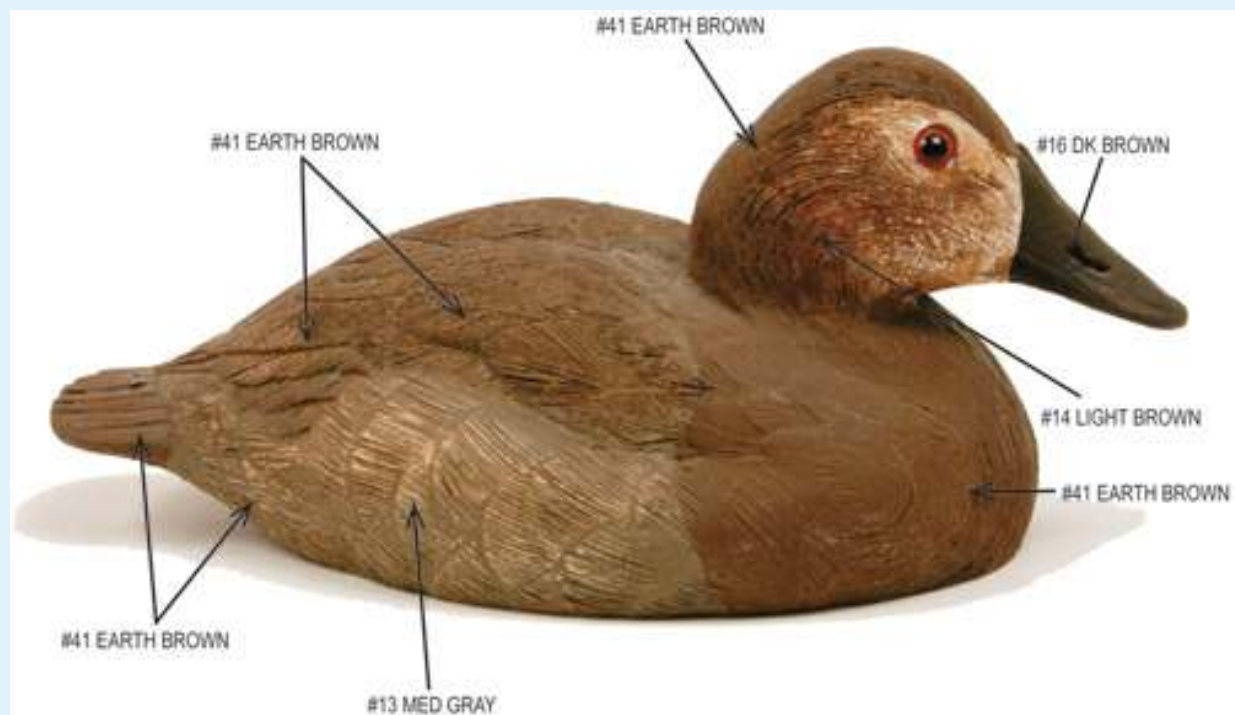
*Males have yellow bills instead of the olive green depicted

5. Canvasback

Male (drake):



Female (hen):



Duck Information Guide

Mallard (*Anas platyrhynchos*)



Image from Wikimedia Commons

Physical Characteristics

Adult male mallards have a glossy green head, white neck ring, chestnut-brown chest, gray body, and distinctive, black central tail feathers. Adult female mallards are mottled brown with an orange bill. Mallards typically measure 20–26 inches in length with a wingspan of 32–39 inches.

Behavior and Feeding Habits

Mallards are dabbling ducks, meaning they feed primarily on the water's surface or by tipping their bodies underwater to reach aquatic plants, insects, and small fish.

Habitat Distribution

Mallards can live in a variety of habitats, including freshwater lakes, rivers, ponds, marshes, and urban parks. They are highly adaptable and can be found in both rural and urban environments.

Mallards are very widely distributed in the world. They can be found across North America, Europe, Asia, Oceania, and parts of Africa. They breed in the northern parts of the world, and they migrate south in the winter.

Mallards are the ancestors of many domestic duck breeds, making them a crucial part of duck breeding history. They are known for their distinct vocalizations, including the familiar "quack" sound made by females.

Adaptations

As ducks, mallards have several adaptations that help them survive. Mallards have broad, flat bills that help them filter food from water, and they have waxy feathers that make them waterproof. Mallards also have webbed feet, which helps them swim better.

Redhead (*Aythya americana*)



Image from Wikimedia Commons

Physical Characteristics

Adult male redheads have a distinctive reddish head and neck, which contrasts with their pale gray body. Adult male redheads also have a black chest and tail. Female and juvenile redheads have a more subtle appearance with a brownish head and body. Redheads measure around 16–20 inches in length with a wingspan of 28–32 inches.

Behavior and Feeding Habits

Redhead ducks are diving ducks. This means they dive deep underwater for relatively long periods of time to search for food. They primarily feed on aquatic plants, seeds, and small invertebrates.

Habitat Distribution

Redheads live in freshwater habitats such as marshes, ponds, and lakes across North America. During migration, they can also be found in coastal estuaries and shallow bays in the southern regions of the United States. However, their breeding grounds are up north, in the northern great plains and prairie pothole regions of the United States and Canada.

The redhead duck is not only a beautiful species but also an important indicator of wetland health. By learning about and protecting these ducks and their habitats, we can ensure they continue to thrive in the wild.

Adaptations

As ducks, redheads have several adaptations that help them survive. Redheads have broad, flat bills that help them filter food from water, and they have waxy feathers that make them waterproof. Redheads also have webbed feet, which helps them swim better.

Northern Pintail (*Anas acuta*)



Image from Wikimedia Commons

Physical Characteristics

Adult male pintails have a chocolate-brown head with a white stripe running from the throat to the back of the neck, a gray body and long central tail feathers. Female pintails are mottled brown with a pointed tail. Northern pintails typically measure 20-29 inches in length with a wingspan of 30-35 inches.

Behavior and Feeding Habits

Northern pintails are dabbling ducks, feeding primarily on the water's surface or by tipping their bodies to reach aquatic plants, seeds, and invertebrates. They are also known to graze on land for grains and grasses.

Habitat Distribution

Northern pintails live in a variety of wetland habitats, including marshes, lakes, ponds, and estuaries. They breed across northern North America, Europe, and Asia; they migrate south to warmer regions during the winter. During migration, northern pintails can be found in large flocks in both freshwater and coastal habitats.

The northern pintail is named for its long, pointed central tail feathers, which are particularly noticeable in flight. Northern pintails often form mixed-species flocks during migration, associating with other dabbling ducks like mallards and American wigeons.

Adaptations

As ducks, pintails have several adaptations that help them survive. Pintails have broad, flat bills that help them filter food from water, and they have waxy feathers that make them waterproof. Pintails also have webbed feet, which helps them swim better.

American Black Duck (*Anas rubripes*)

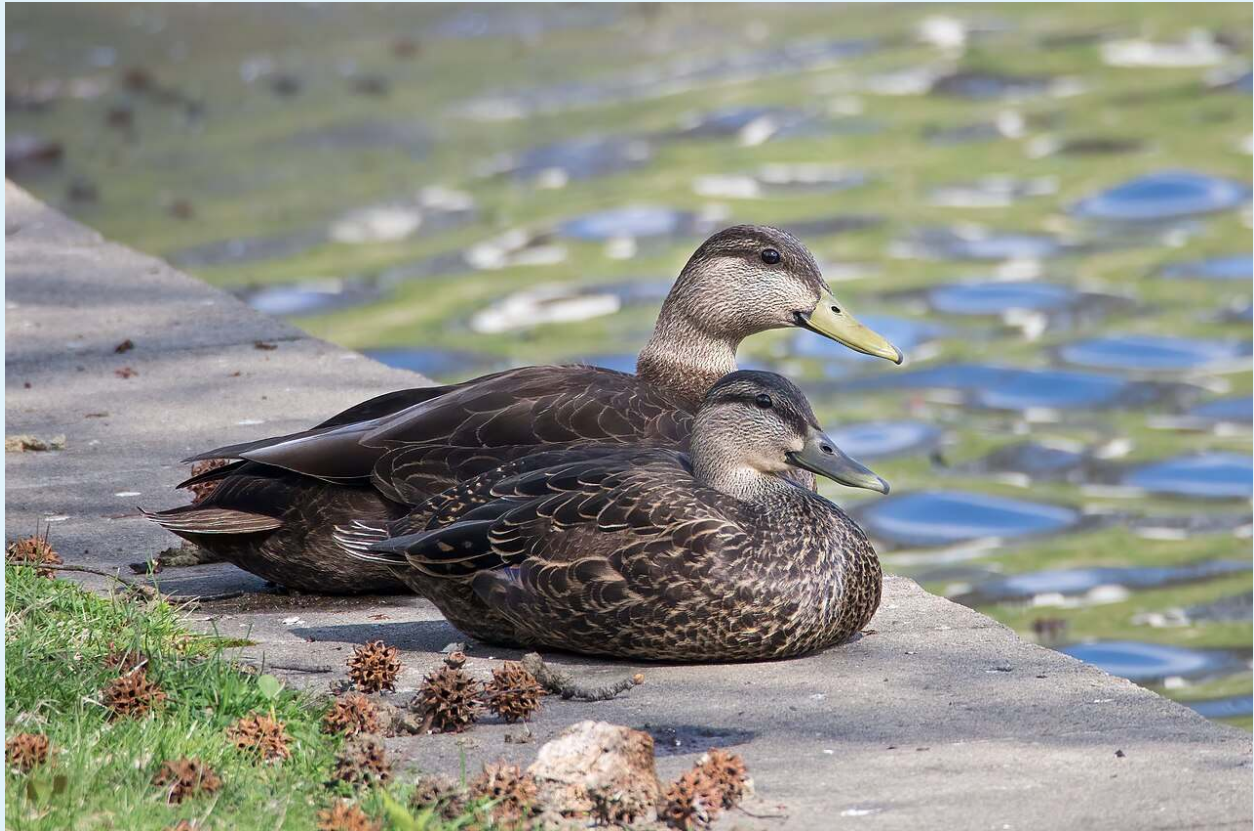


Image from Wikimedia Commons

Physical Characteristics

Adult male and female black ducks look very similar. They both have a darker brown, mottled body and light brown head. However, male black ducks have bright yellow bills, while female black ducks have yellow-green (sometimes described as olive) bills. This is the easiest way to tell the two apart. Black ducks are quite big compared to other ducks. They measure 21-23 inches in length and 35-37 inches in wingspan.

Behavior and Feeding Habits

Black ducks are dabbling ducks. This means that they feed primarily on the water's surface or by tipping their bodies just below the water's surface. Black ducks have a diverse diet, they will eat plants, snails, insects, small fishes, and more.

Habitat Distribution

The American black duck is distributed across the whole eastern half of North America. They breed in Canada and migrate to the southeastern United States during the winter. However, not all black ducks migrate. Black ducks in regions where the winter is less harsh, like in New England (as opposed to northern Canada), may stay in the same place year-round.

Adaptations

As ducks, black ducks have several adaptations that help them survive. Black ducks have broad, flat bills that help them filter food from water, and they have waxy feathers that make them waterproof. Black ducks also have webbed feet, which helps them swim better.

Canvasback (*Aythya valisineria*)

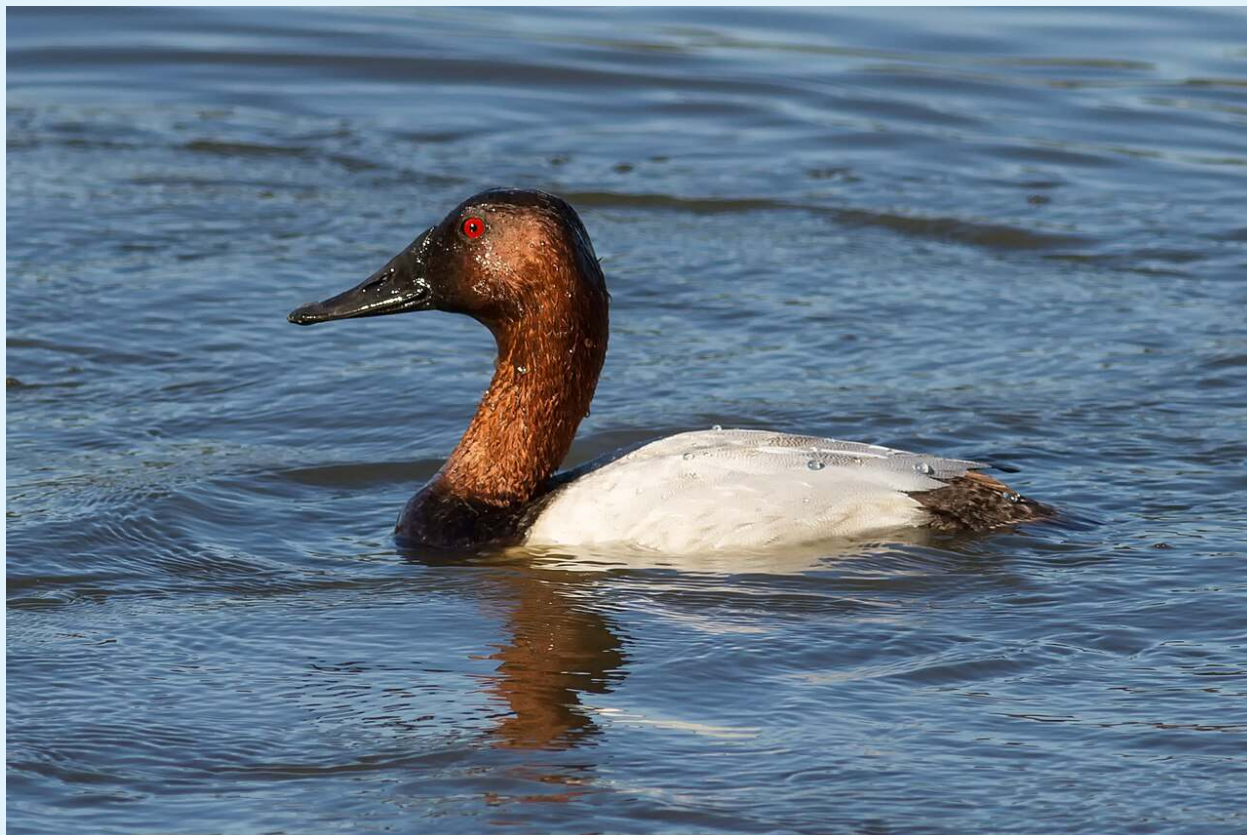


Image from Wikimedia Commons

Physical Characteristics

Adult male canvasbacks have a black bill, red head, gray back, and dark tail. Adult female pintails have a black bill, light brown head, and darker brown body. A distinct characteristic of the canvasback is that they have long, thin necks. Canvasbacks are around 19–22 inches in length and have a wingspan of 31–35 inches.

Behavior and Feeding Habits

Black ducks are diving ducks, meaning that they dive deep underwater to search for food. However, sometimes they will look for food near the surface of the water, too. Canvasbacks used to eat a lot of aquatic plants. However, as the amount of marshland decreased due to human development, these ducks have mostly shifted to eating clams.

Habitat Distribution

Canvasbacks live throughout North America, even in Alaska. They breed in the far north. In the winter, canvasbacks fly south via the Mississippi Flyway. Canvasbacks are highly migratory birds, and they used to winter in the Chesapeake Bay in the hundreds of thousands. However, a decrease in aquatic plants in the region has caused them to migrate more toward the Mississippi Valley nowadays.

Canvasbacks used to be hunted in large numbers and were prized as food, which caused a sharp decline in their population. More recent regulations have helped canvasback populations slowly recover.

Adaptations

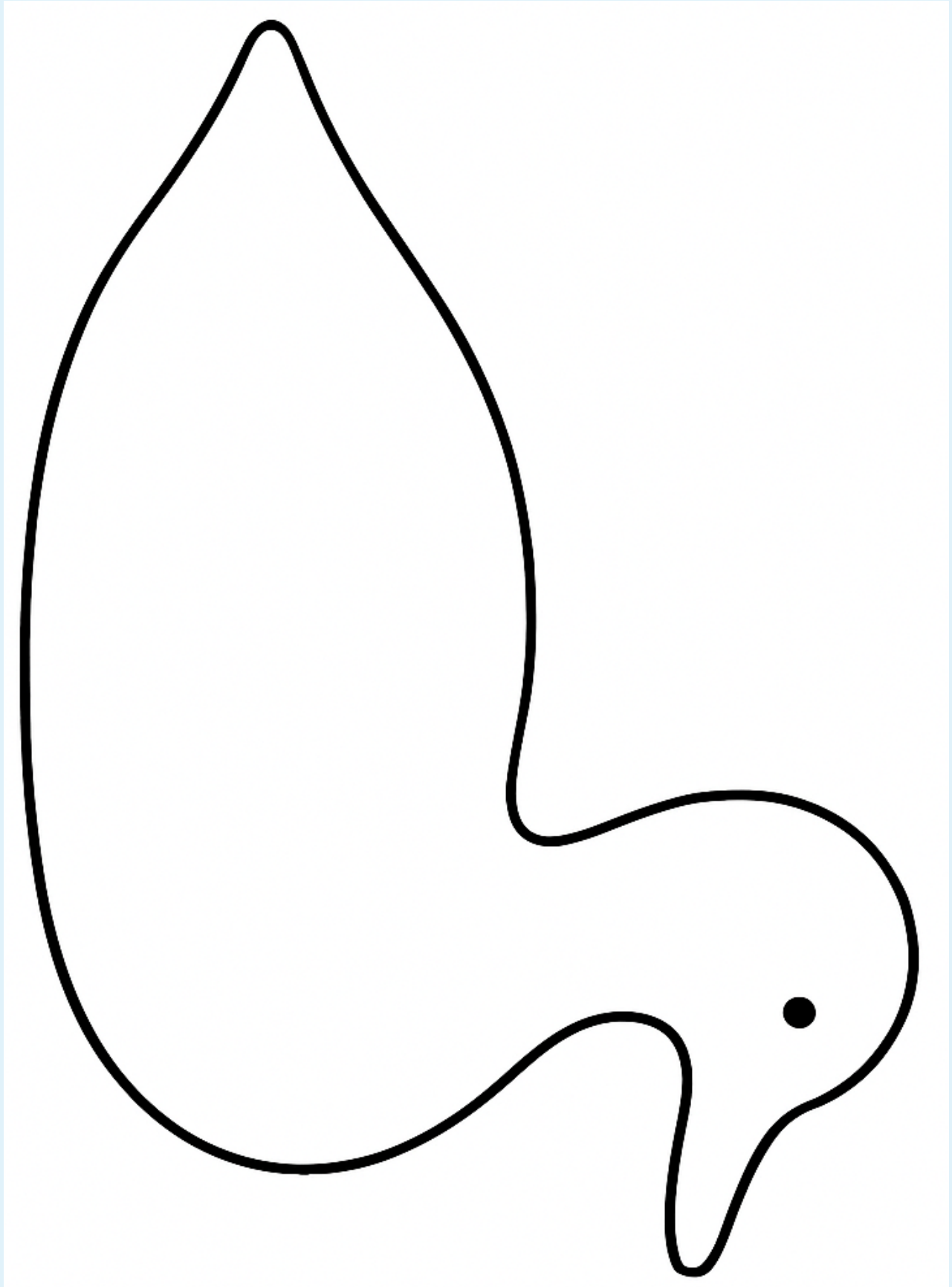
As ducks, canvasbacks have several adaptations that help them survive. Canvasbacks have broad, flat bills that help them filter food from water, and they have waxy feathers that make them waterproof. Canvasbacks also have webbed feet, which helps them swim better.

Pages 33 – 47 are in a separate PDF in Google Drive folder

Sample Internet Resources

This page contains a list of internet resources that may be helpful to students' research, should they choose to go online. We do not intend these to be comprehensive; they are a starting point.

- Waterfowl ID: <https://www.ducks.org/hunting/waterfowl-id>
- Avian Report:
<https://avianreport.com/north-carolina-ducks-geese-swans-id-guide/>
- Birdwatching Central:
<https://birdwatchingcentral.com/ducks-in-north-carolina/>
- Ducks at a Distance:
<https://www.fws.gov/sites/default/files/documents/ducks%20at%20a%20distance-ocr.pdf>
- Birds of Beaufort NC:
<https://www.megforward.com/birds/index.php/2024/02/11/puddle-ducks/>



Activity 2 – “Present a Duck Species”

Overview

In this activity, students will learn about one specific species of duck or waterfowl found in North America. Then, they can do a short presentation on the species using either their hand-painted duck model or one of the decoys in the crate as prop.

 **30–60 min.**

Materials

- duck models from Activity 1 OR decoy ducks provided in crate
- duck information packets from Activity 1 (two versions in binder)
- *The Super Book of Ducks* (in crate)
- sample internet resources from Activity 1 (optional, one copy in binder)
- access to internet (optional)
- research worksheet (one copy in binder)

Step-by-Step Instructions

5. Assign the duck species in the Duck Information Packet to students. Alternatively, have students choose their own preferred duck species. Students can work individually on this project, or work in teams organized by duck species.
6. Have each student or group research their duck species for **30 minutes**. This can be done with the duck information packet, *The Super Book of Ducks*, or appropriate internet resources (the sample internet resources document provides a few starting points). If the research was already completed in Activity 1, this step may be skipped.
7. Instruct students or groups to fill out the research worksheet (make copies from the template provided) while researching. This demonstrates their understanding and prepares them for the presentation.
8. Let the students or groups prepare their presentations for **10 minutes**. They can practice with the duck models they made in Activity 1 or decoy ducks in the crate.
9. Presentation time! We recommend **roughly 1 minute of presentation time** per participant or group.
10. Ask participants to reflect on what they learned from other presentations.

 "Present a Duck Species" Worksheet **My Duck Species is:**

What does your duck species look like? Remember to show, not tell.

Find your duck's typical length and wingspan:

Describe your duck's **diet** – what does it eat?

Find where your duck lives.

Share where your duck migrates to for the winter.

What are some adaptations of your duck species, and explain how they help your duck survive?

Share what makes your duck species special.

Activity 3 – “Decoy Hunters”

Overview

It's duck migration season! Unfortunately for the ducks, some of their friends aren't what they seem. Can you spot your own duck in a sea of lookalikes?

 **30–40 min.**

Materials

- everything from Activity 1
- camou clothing from Activity 13 (optional, in crate)

Step-by-Step Instructions

1. Split the students into two teams: duck team and hunter team. Aim to have one duck for every two hunters. If this cannot be done, it is preferred to have more hunters.
2. If Activity 1 has been completed, skip this step. Give each duck team member **15 minutes** to model their duck according to the instructions in Activity 1 (either clay or coloring option is viable, and the research may be skipped for time's sake). However, this time, **they are not allowed to color the back**. Once each duck team member is done modeling their duck, **mark the back of their duck with an “R”** (pencil might be better to avoid bleeding through) standing for “Real.” Collaboration amongst the duck team is allowed.
3. If Activity 1 has been completed, have the duck team **mark their models on one side with an “R”** standing for real. Possibly use a sticky note if the students do not wish for their crafts to be permanently marked up. Duck team members should deliberate on how to recognize each other's models.
4. Hand the “R” ducks to the hunter team. Give the hunter team members **15 minutes** to model one duck per member according to the steps in Activity 1. The hunters should aim to mimic any of the “R” ducks. **They are not allowed to color the back or modify any “R” duck**. The ducks made by the hunter team should be **marked on the back with a “D”** for decoy.
5. Collect all the ducks, shuffle them, and place them letter-side-down on a table.
6. Have the duck team line up. Each duck, in the order they lined up in, must go to the table and select one duck that they believe to be one of their own “R” ducks. After choosing, they must flip over that duck and reveal whether it was real.

- a. If it was real, that duck member survives and goes to the back of the line, with the possibility of having to choose another duck if they return to the front. The "R" duck is removed from the table.
 - b. If it was decoy, that team member is eliminated. The decoy duck is removed from the table.
7. Continue playing until either...
 - a. ...every real duck was selected. In this case, the duck team wins!
 - b. ...every duck team member was eliminated. In that case, the hunters win!

Modifications

- Allow member(s) of the hunter team to dress up as duck hunters with the camouflage clothing provided in the crate.
- Allow the duck team to dress up as ducks! Provide or make duck costumes
- Experiment with the ratio between ducks and hunters. Add more ducks if you find that the duck team keeps losing, and vice versa.

Activity 4 – “Place Your Decoy”

Overview

Want to step into the shoes of a duck hunter? Try placing blinds and decoys yourself and justify your choice to your classmates.

 **30–40 min.**

Materials

- 5 sets of maps (in crate)
- 5 sets of 3 duck blinds plus 20 decoy duck cutouts (in crate)
- ***Digital version of activity materials can be found at:**
<https://canva.link/y0lc37whocpqjei>*
 - Make sure to print these single-sided.
- decoy-placing cheat sheet (one copy in binder)
- camou clothing from Activity 13 (optional, in crate)

Step-by-Step Instructions

11. Divide students up into 5 or fewer groups
12. Allocate approximately **10 minutes** for students to read over the decoy-placing cheat sheet.
13. Allow about **10 minutes** for students to place a blind of their choosing and decoy duck cutouts onto each map. Students can exercise their creativity, but the goal is also that they should use the knowledge they learned from the cheat sheet.
14. Allow students to present to each other about why they placed their blinds and decoys as they did. Students should be able to cite points from the cheat sheet that they read and implemented.
15. If desired, students can vote on the best-placed decoy formation, and person(s) from that group can dress up in the camou clothing and get a picture as the reward.

Keys to Maps and Cutouts

- Map:
 -  blue regions mean water. Stake and boat blinds can go there, but not shore blinds.
 -  yellow regions mean marsh. Stake or shore blinds can go there.
 -  green regions mean shrubs. Not a good place for blinds, but shore blinds will work.

- Cutouts:

Blinds (each group gets one of each and chooses one out of the three)



A boat blind: boat covered in matting



A shore blind: wire frame covered in matting



A stake blind: wooden box on stilts covered in shrubbery



Decoy duck (each group gets 20)

Decoy-Placing Cheat Sheet

In this cheat sheet, you will get a quick overview of the different types of duck hunting blinds, as well as some tips on how to place decoys.

Types of Duck Blinds

A blind is a place where hunters stay when they are waiting for ducks to come, and duck hunters want their blinds to blend into the surrounding landscape as much as possible. When ducks fly by the blind, hunters shoot at the ducks from the blind. There are three types of blinds: stake, boat, and shore.

- Stake blinds are built upon platforms in the water supported on stilts. Often, they are created from old piers. In order to set up the actual blind, hunters would often build a wooden “hut” which they could dismantle and assemble onto the pier. As a finishing touch, these blinds are covered in foliage to make them blend into the marsh. A popular way to do this is to put myrtle branches all over the blind.



A stake blind

- Boat blinds are constructed on top of boats. To make it hard for ducks to distinguish, hunters would go long distances to completely cover their boat in straw or foliage. Boat blinds have the advantage of being mobile. If a location is not good for hunting ducks, the hunter can simply steer the boat to a different location.



A boat blind

- Shore blinds are small huts set up near bodies of water. In protected areas of Down East, setting up shore blinds requires obtaining registration from the parks service. These blinds usually feature a frame made from chicken wire or other types of bendable, strong material. Then, the hunters would put grass mats on top so the whole set up disappears into the marsh landscape.



A shore blind

A Note on Decoys

Hunting ducks requires a large number of decoys. Because ducks usually travel in flocks of hundreds to thousands, a couple of decoy ducks on the water will not attract anything. Typically, a hunter would lay out anywhere from 200–250 decoy ducks near the blind to mimic a true duck flock. You will use around 20 decoys for this activity to keep numbers manageable.

Decoys work because ducks are looking for two f's: **f**ood and **f**riendship. Decoys might not account for the food, but they might look like potential mates to ducks flying by. This is the reason behind the effectiveness of decoys.

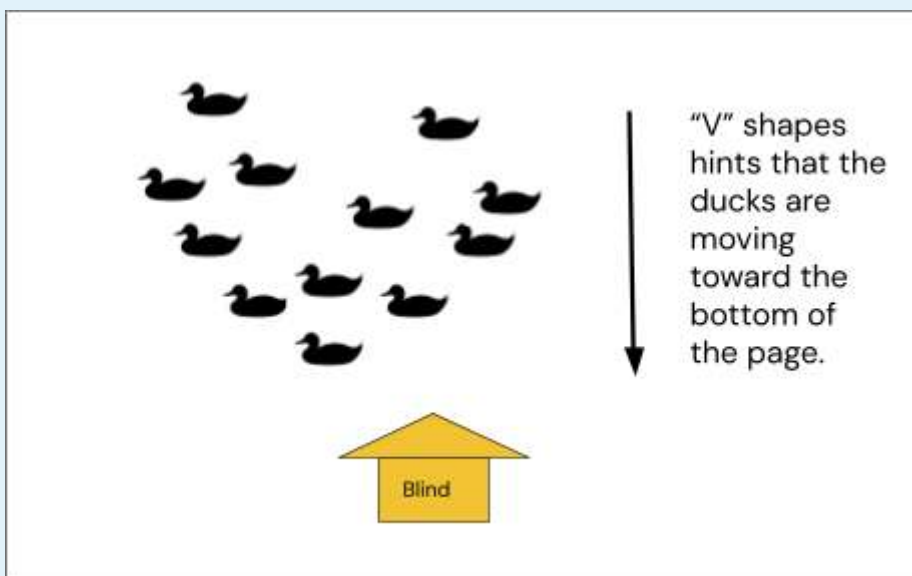
Fun fact: to put hundreds of decoys out quickly, hunters would sometimes string the decoys on weighted lines or nets. This allows them to deploy many decoys at once.

Decoy-Placing Strategies

Decoy-placement is often more of an art than an exact science. However, we will introduce two strategies to help maximize your chance of attracting ducks.

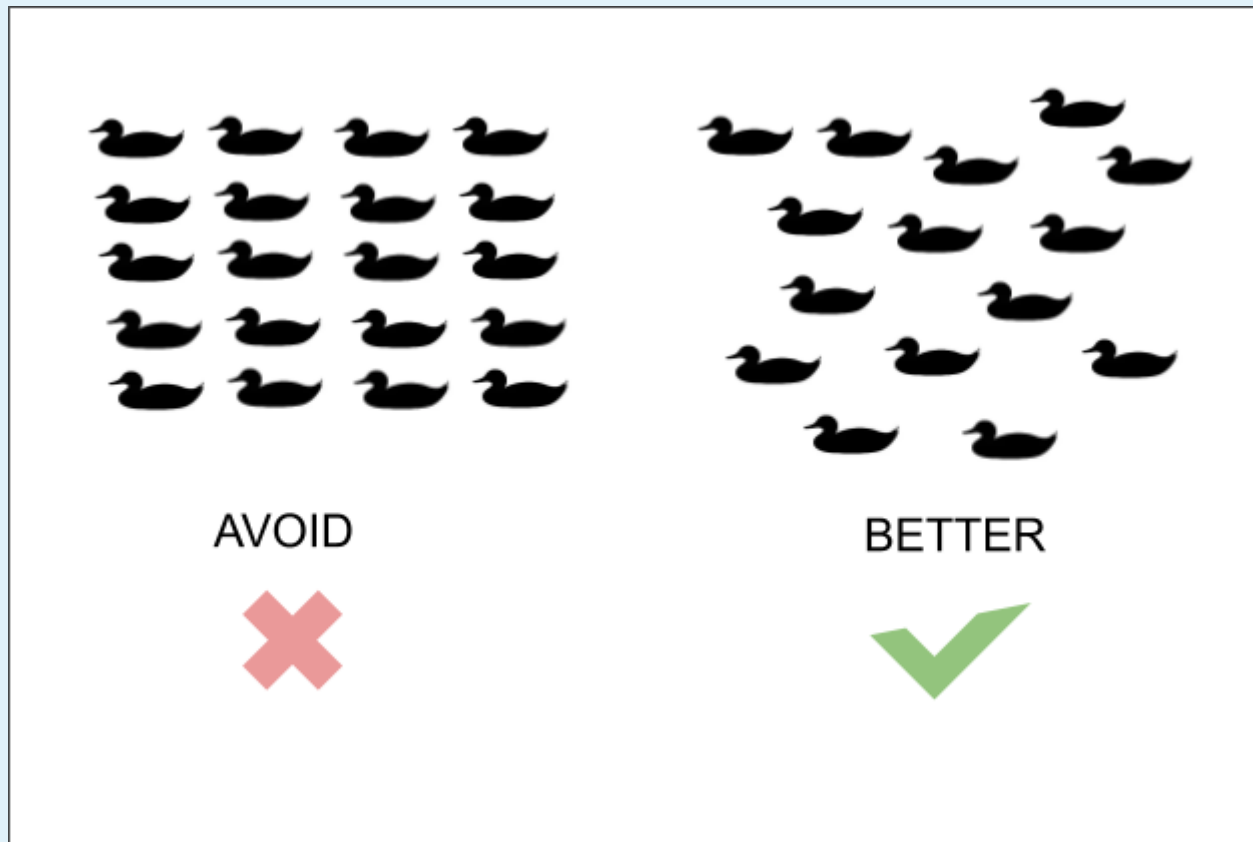
Strategy 1: Use "V"s

Ducks often travel in "V" shapes. By placing decoys in a "V" formation, your decoys look like they are moving in the direction of the tip of the "V". When ducks fly by, they may be attracted to also go toward the tip of the "V", where you can place your duck-hunting blind.



Strategy 2: Avoid Being too Geometrical

Ducks rarely travel in perfect lines. If your decoy placement seems too perfect (sharp edges, straight lines, etc.), the ducks may become suspicious. Adding a little randomness or curvature can make the decoy formation look more natural and convincing.



Activity 5 – “Decoy, Carver, Fowl, Drake, Hen”

Overview

Be the first one to exhaust your deck of cards as you and your group shout, slap, and perform various actions! This game is closely modeled off of Taco Cat Goat Cheese Pizza.

NOTE: The deck of cards provided can support up to 21 total players.

 **20–30 min.**

Materials

- “Decoy, Carver, Fowl, Drake, Hen” card deck (in crate)
- ***Digital version of activity materials can be found at:**
<https://canva.link/Ocmpj7qpql4chuu>*
 - When printing, make sure you do double-sided! Then, cut along the card-shaped lines.

Step-by-Step Instructions

1. Divide your students into mini-groups of 4–8 players each.
2. Give each mini-group 10 cards per group member.
3. Have each mini-group shuffle and distribute their cards evenly between group members. **Remind participants that they cannot look at their cards.**
4. Within each mini-group, the game should play out as follows:
 - a. Youngest goes first and places the card from the top of their deck onto the discard pile, face-up. Simultaneously, they should say “Decoy!”
 - b. Go clockwise through the group, with each group member saying the next word in the cycle “Decoy, Carver, Fowl, Drake, Hen.” If at any point, the card a player places down matches the word that player says, all group members must slap that card. The last person to slap the card takes the entire discard pile and adds it to their personal deck.
 - c. If the “DUCK” card is placed, all players must quickly begin flapping their arms and quacking. If any player doesn’t do so, they must take the entire discard pile and add it to their personal deck.
 - d. If a species card (“Mallard,” “Pintail,” “Redhead”) is placed, all players must slap the card **ONLY** if the picture on the card matches the word on the card. If

they don't match, the first person to slap the card must take the entire discard pile and add it to their personal deck.

- e. The first player to exhaust their personal deck wins after the next "slap."
5. The "slap" can be replaced with raising hands or "nose goes," if desired.

Activity 6 – “Four Duck Corners”

Overview

Get moving with the ducky twist on a classic elimination game! Participants choose corners and try not to be eliminated. But now, rather than simply pick a corner, the person who is “it” must also know what the duck species are...

 **30 min.**

Materials

- duck species collection (one copy in binder)
- list of duck species (one copy in binder)
- open area, outdoors or indoors
- tape (optional but recommended, not in crate)

Step-by-Step Instructions

16. Determine who will be “it” first. This can be done randomly or with volunteers.
17. Randomly choose three duck pictures from the duck species collection. These species will be the labels for three of the corners. The fourth corner will always be “decoy.”
18. Place the corresponding duck pictures (plus a decoy) in their respective corners. You may use tape to affix the cutouts to a wall, if appropriate. The correct species is labeled in the bottom right corner of each picture in small font.
19. Have the person who is “it” count down from 10 with their eyes closed. During this countdown period, everyone else must pick one of the four corners.
20. After the “it” person is done counting, have them open their eyes and pick a corner. After choosing a corner, they must correctly identify the duck species at that corner, or say “decoy” if they chose the decoy corner. They may reference the list of duck species, but cannot look at other resources.
 - a. If the “it” person is correct, everyone in that corresponding corner is eliminated from the game. If this corner is the “decoy” corner, the “it” person must choose someone from that corner to remain in the game and be “it” next (everyone else is eliminated). If this corner is one of the three duck species, the “it” person may continue to be “it” or choose someone else still

in the game to be “it” next – afterwards, randomly choose another duck species to replace the species in that corner.

- b. If the “it” person is incorrect, nothing happens, and the “it” person must choose someone else (who is still in the game) to be “it” next. Alternatively, the instructor may randomly choose who to be “it” next.
21. When there are less than 5 people in the game, the decoy corner is replaced with a duck species.

Example

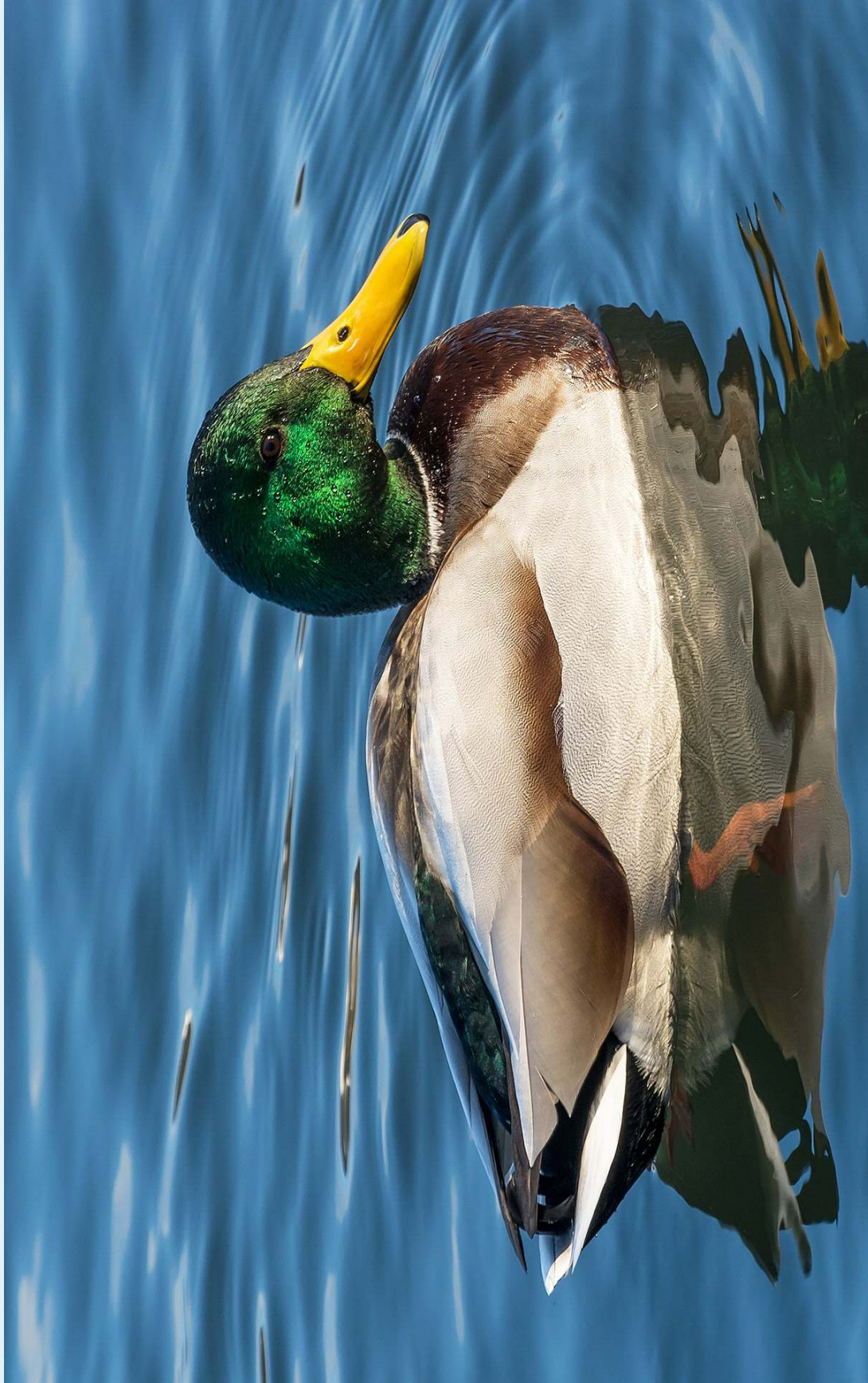
- Alex is “it.” The four corners are “decoy,” “Black Duck,” “Mallard,” and “Redhead.” Alex counts down from 10 and picks the “Black Duck” corner, but incorrectly guesses that corner’s duck to be the Redhead. No one is eliminated, and Alex chooses Brandon to be “it” next.
- Brandon is now “it,” and chooses the “Mallard” corner. They correctly guess that corner’s duck to be the Mallard. Everyone in that corner is now eliminated, and the instructor randomly chooses the Canvasback to replace the Mallard corner.
- Brandon is still “it,” and chooses the “Decoy” corner. Claire is one of the people in the “decoy” corner, and Brandon chooses Claire to be “it” next. Everyone else in the “decoy” corner is now eliminated.
- After several eliminations, Claire and Alex are the two people left in the game. Alex is now “it,” and chooses the “Black Duck” corner, where Claire chose to stand. Alex correctly guesses that corner’s duck to be the Black Duck. Claire is eliminated, and Alex wins!

List of Duck Species (Four Duck Corners)

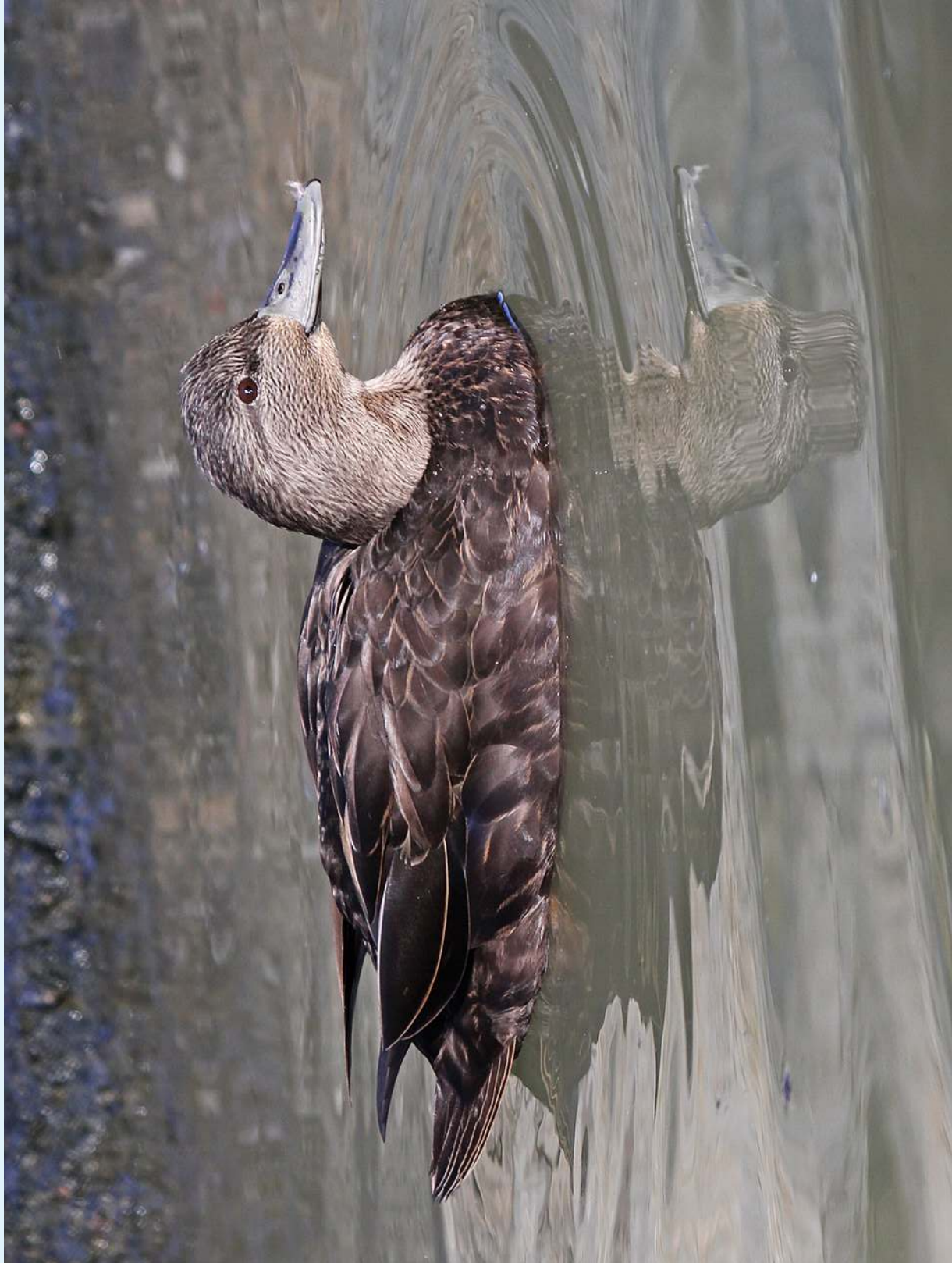
- 1. Redhead**
- 2. American Black Duck**
- 3. Mallard**
- 4. Northern Pintail**
- 5. Canvasback**



Redhead



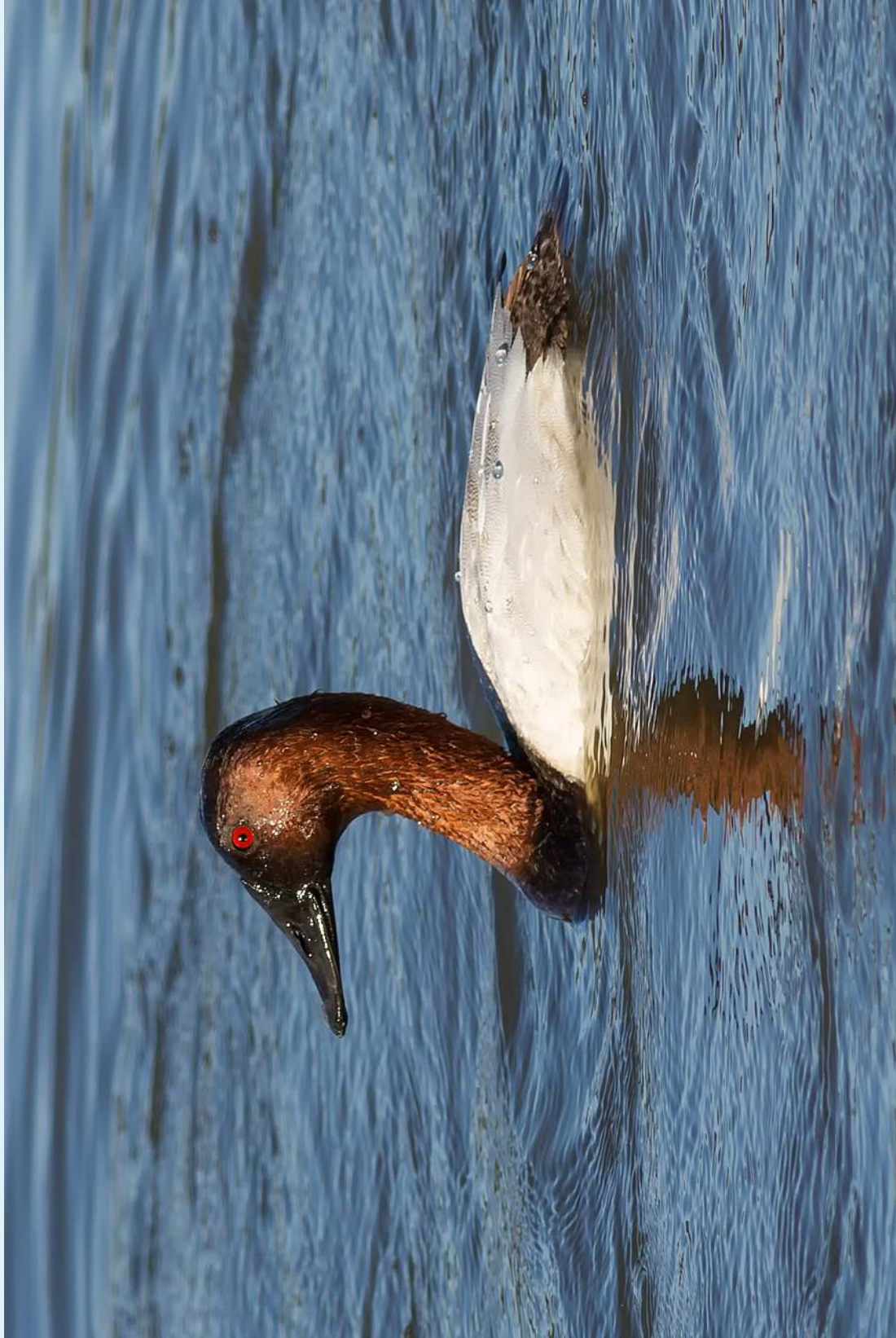
Mallard



Black duck



Northern pintail



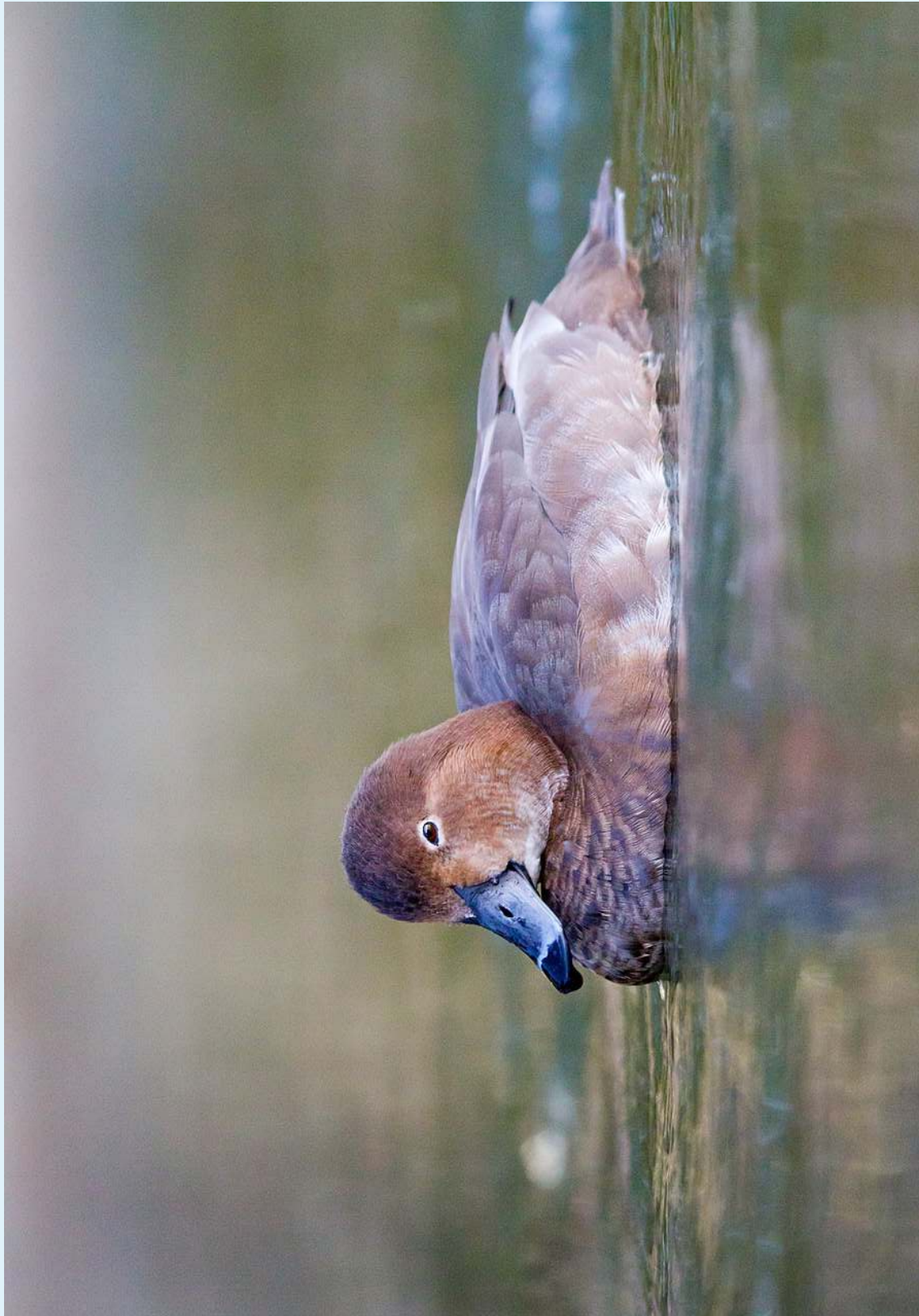
Canvasback



Canvasback



Northern pintail



Redhead

DECOY

Activity 7 – “Write it, Draw it”

Overview

Test your teamwork and communication skills with this duck variation on a famous Science Olympiad activity. Do you really work well with your best friend? The ducks will decide...

 **30–40 min.**

Materials

- duck species poster (two versions in crate)
- writing and drawing utensils (not in crate)
- blank paper (not in crate)

Step-by-Step Instructions

8. Split your group into pairs. A group of three may be formed, if necessary.
9. Have one person in each pair be “the chooser.” They must choose a random waterfowl species. Refer to the large duck species poster found in this crate. Remind participants that the other person(s) in the pair may not look at or be told the duck species their partner chose.
10. Give each chooser **10 minutes** to describe their duck on a sheet of paper. They may not write more than 20 words, and cannot write the duck’s species anywhere on the paper. Writing down codes or non-biological information is strongly discouraged.
11. After time is up, have the choosers hand off their 20 word or less description to their partner(s) – the do-ers. The do-ers must now draw the duck their partner described, and identify the species by writing it on the back of the paper. The chooser cannot communicate with the do-er. Give do-ers **10 minutes**.
12. After time is up, every pair whose do-er correctly identified and accurately drew the species that the chooser picked, wins!
13. Encourage each pair or group to reflect on this activity. What went right? What are some opportunities for improvement? What did they learn about communication and working as a team?

Activity 8 – “Duck, Duck, Goose”

Overview

Help your elementary school students learn their phonics with this card game. Unlike the classic game of “Duck, Duck, Goose”, there’s a little less chasing and a lot more learning!

 **30–40 min.**

Materials

- duck duck goose cards (in crate)
- directions sheet (in crate)

Step-by-Step Instructions

14. Have participants sit in a circle around the deck of cards
15. Have participants take turns drawing cards and reading the nonsense word on the card
16. If a participant reads the word correctly, they may choose to draw another card or pass to the next player. If they read the card incorrectly, they must put it back in the deck and their turn is over
17. If the student draws a “Goose” card, they must return all their cards to the bottom of the draw pile and their turn is over
18. If the student draws a “Lose Your Turn!” card, their turn is over
19. If a student draws a “Pass Left/Right!” card, all students must pass their cards to the person on their left or right. The drawers turn is over
20. When there are no cards remaining in the deck, the student with the most cards wins!

Activity 9 – “Connect the Dots”

Overview

An easy and relaxing craft for elementary school students.

Flexible

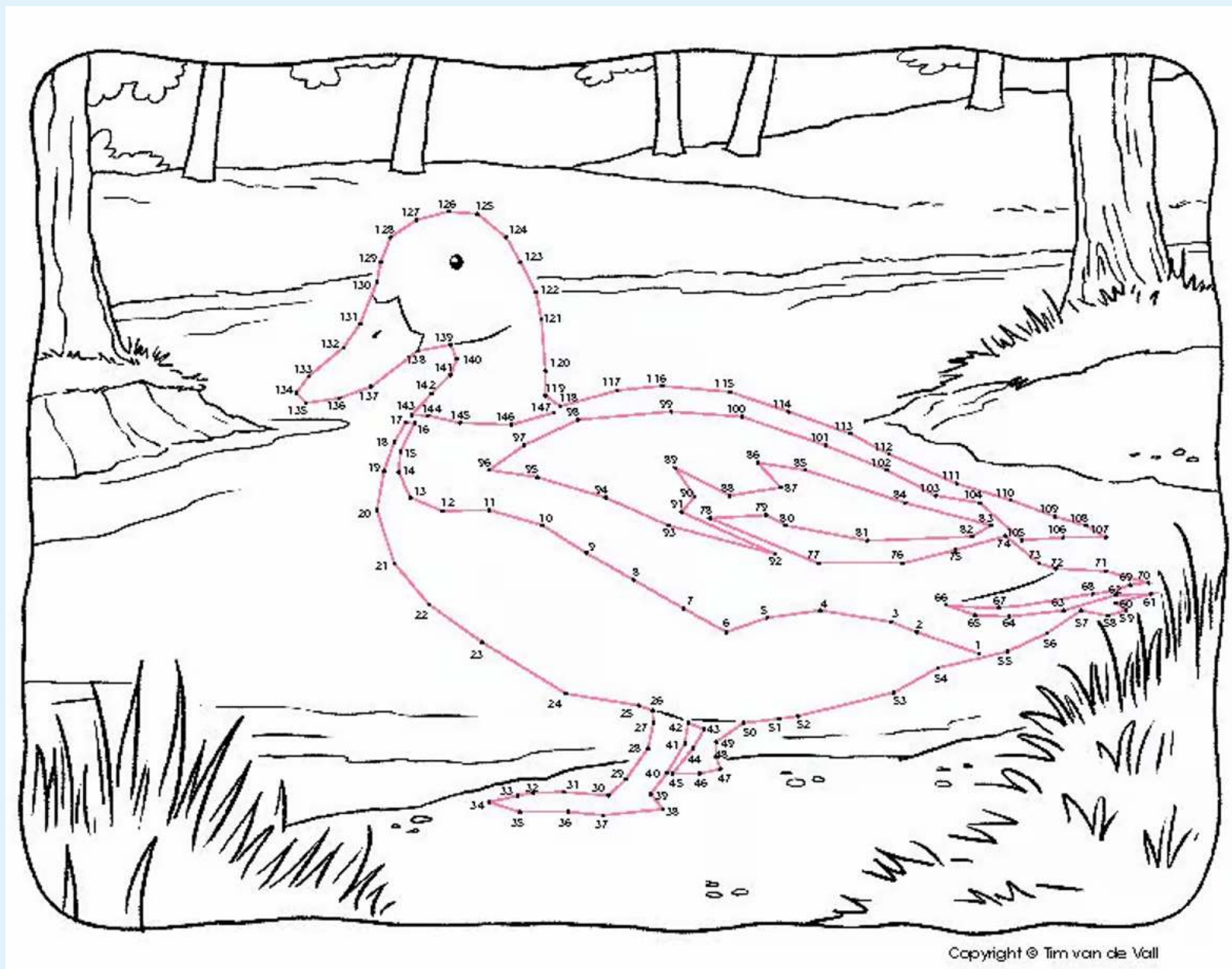
Materials

- connect the dots activity sheets (one copy in binder)
- art supplies (not in crate)

Step-by-Step Instructions

1. Print however many copies of the connect-the-dots activity sheets as you need.
Please do *not* write on the template!
2. Distribute the sheets to your participants and let them work on it.

Connect the Dots - Waterfowl Edition





Activity 10 – “Word Search”



Overview

- Have students complete a duck-related word search as part of your classroom warm-up or wind-down.



Flexible



Materials

- decoy duck word search sheets (one copy each in binder)



Step-by-Step Instructions

21. Print however many copies of word searches as needed. Please *do not* write on the template provided.
22. Distribute each activity to your participants and let them have fun.

Pages 78 – 80 are in separate PDFs in Google Drive folder

Activity 11 – “Duck Bingo”

Overview

An easy and relaxing game for elementary school students.

Flexible

Materials

- decoy duck bingo sheet templates (one copy each in binder)
- decoy Duck Bingo Instructor Sheet (one copy in binder)
- camouflage clothing from Activity 13 (optional, in crate)
- writing utensils (not in crate)

Step-by-Step Instructions

1. Print however many copies of the bingo sheets as you need. Please *do not* write on the template!
2. Distribute the sheets to your participants and start the bingo. An instructor sheet (that can be copied and written on) is available to assist you during the game.
3. Bingo time!
4. If desired, the winner can dress up in duck hunting camouflage clothing.

Decoy Duck Bingo Instructor Sheet

Items

- ☐ Carver
- ☐ Mallard
- ☐ Pintail
- ☐ Redhead
- ☐ Black duck
- ☐ Drake
- ☐ Hen
- ☐ Canvasback
- ☐ Cap (camou)
- ☐ Coat (camou)
- ☐ Marsh
- ☐ Stake blind
- ☐ Boat blind
- ☐ Shore blind
- ☐ Dog
- ☐ Gadwall
- ☐ Wigeon
- ☐ Wood duck
- ☐ Atlantic flyway
- ☐ Mississippi flyway
- ☐ Migration
- ☐ Decoy
- ☐ Swan
- ☐ Duck call
- ☐ Core sound
- ☐ Outer banks
- ☐ Down East
- ☐ Diving ducks
- ☐ Dabbling duck

Pages 83 – 98 are in a separate PDF in Google Drive folder

Activity 12 – “Duck Coloring Sheets”

Overview

Have your students show off their coloring skills with the included coloring sheets. Some extra math and content are also available

Flexible

Materials

- duck coloring sheets (one copy each in binder)
- *Mid-Atlantic & Southeast Duck Migration Guide* from Activity 1 (optional, in crate)

Step-by-Step Instructions

1. Make as many copies of the template coloring sheets in the binder as needed (please don't write on the template), then distribute them to your students. A few bonuses to note:
 - a. One coloring sheet is based on math. The male wood duck is sure difficult to color, but being good at addition will make the process easier!
 - b. We have also included a series of bird flyway coloring sheets. These can be a good learning experience about duck migration, coupled with the *Mid-Atlantic & Southeast Duck Migration Guide* from Activity 1.

Pages 100 – 111 are in separate PDFs in Google Drive folder



Activity 13 – “Duck Storytime”

Overview

Enjoy some quiet after-recess storytime! Informational and duck themed of course...

Depends on Book

Materials

- Books (in crate):
 - *Go Duck Hunting* by Lisa M. Bolt Simons
 - *Bird Watch* by Storey Publishing
 - *Duck Hunt* by Ryan Eubank, illustrated by Louise Saunders
 - *Bird Dogs* by Ryan Eubank, illustrated by Louise Saunders
 - *The Duck Shack* by Kevin Lovegreen, illustrated by Margarita Sikorskaia
 - *Ducks Don't Get Wet* by Augusta Goldin, illustrated by Helen Davie

Book Synopses for the Instructor

23. ***Go Duck Hunting*** – Readers will learn about duck hunting, including the rules, gear, common practices, and history.
24. ***Bird Watch*** – Complete with its own mini magnifying glass, stickers, and craft instructions, this book walks readers through different bird species. Best read outside!
25. ***Duck Hunt*** – Perfect for introducing young children to duck hunting.
26. ***Bird Dogs*** – Depicts the different kinds of hunting dogs and how they assist people on their duck hunts.
27. ***The Duck Shack*** – Join Luke and Crystal on a duck hunting adventure as they learn about the rules, tips, and challenges of duck hunting. This is a short chapter book for more advanced readers.
28. ***Ducks Don't Get Wet*** – This book explores the fascinating adaptations of ducks that help them survive. A short and informational read.

Activity 14 – “Dress Like a Hunter”

Overview

Head-to-toe camou clothing is a classic aspect of duck hunting. We invite your students to try it out!

 **40 min.**

Materials

- Camouflage clothing (in crate)
- Duck call (in crate)
- Nature space (optional)

Step-by-Step Instructions

1. Teach students about the importance of camou clothing in duck-hunting. More details can be found in the conceptual materials section of this binder. A small photo collection from Chris Yeomans, a Down East duck hunter, is also included with this activity. Note the photos are a little blurry.
2. Have students take turns trying on the camou clothing included in this crate. We’ve also included orange vests that hunters wear.
3. If desired, a good exercise is to have students wear the camou clothing outside. Compare to see how much more camou blends into the natural scenery than everyday clothes! Also note how well the orange vests stand out.
4. We also include a duck call in the crate for this activity. Hunters use duck calls to make duck sounds and attract ducks. If you choose to use it, please just make sure to wipe down the call thoroughly between different users, and before returning the crate.





Activity 15 – “Decoy Duck Tutorial Video”

Overview

Introduce students to the steps of carving a wooden decoy duck with these short videos. Hear it from the experts!

 **20–30 min.**

Materials

- decoy carving videos:
https://drive.google.com/drive/folders/1ayKTJVOCf2xjlwNy2HeOMiYEPo-ethJy?usp=s_haring
- decoy carving poster (in crate)
- student worksheet (one copy in binder)
- answer key (one copy in binder)

Step-by-Step Instructions

1. This tutorial is split into two parts:
 - a. Session 1: From Block to Body. Covers tracing, rough cutting, and shaping.
 - b. Session 2: Sanding and Finishing Touches. Includes detailed sanding, head-body attachment, and painting.
2. Play each video in full with occasional pauses for class discussion or re-watching key steps. Alternatively, there is a decoy carving information poster in the crate if you would rather teach from physical material.
3. Have students fill out the worksheet while watching
4. Review the questions together as a class after each session

Student's Worksheet: Watch Decoy Carving Tutorial Videos

Name: _____ Date: _____

Please answer these questions when you watch the Decoy Carving Tutorial Videos.

Session 1

1. What are the names of the two carvers in the video? Circle two that apply.
a. Jason b. Jordan c. Cole d. Clay
2. What is the first thing the carvers do to begin the decoy carving?
a. Paint the feather and bill
b. Trace the duck's profile onto the wooden block using a pattern
c. Drill a hole on the duck body and head
3. We need to draw center lines on both the head and body before sanding.
a. True b. False
4. When drilling a hole at where the eyes will be, we only need to drill down half of the duck's head.
a. True b. False

Session 2

1. In these two videos, how many steps in total are there in carving a decoy?
a. 5 b. 6 c. 7 d. 8
2. The square where the head will be attached to the body should be flat.
a. True b. False
3. When carving up and down around the widest line of the body, what degree should we keep?
a. 35 b. 40 c. 45 d. 50
4. When sanding the body and head, we need to wear a mask and goggles to protect ourselves.
a. True b. False
5. There's a widest point on the duck head, and we shouldn't touch that point when sanding.
a. True b. False
6. What's the last step of decoy carving?
a. Attach the head to the body
b. Paint the decoy
c. Put the decoy into the water

Key to Decoy Carving Tutorial Video Worksheet

Session 1:

1. a, d
2. b
3. a
4. b

Session 2:

1. d
2. a
3. c
4. a
5. a
6. b

Supplementary Activities

Overview

While compiling activities for this education crate, we came across several good activities that our current crate resources may not be able to support. Some of these are alternative forms of existing activities, some are completely new. We felt that these activities are too good to completely exclude. Therefore, we are including them in the pages following, with the hopes that a creative or adventurous instructor may put them to good use.

Pages 120 – 137 are in separate PDFs in Google Drive folder